

PACKAGING: Last Mile In Product Development

A game-changing perspective on product development, highlighting the often overlooked significance of packaging as the key to customer satisfaction and environmental responsibility



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In a recent product development workshop, a customer made a thought-provoking statement that resonated deeply with the essence of product creation: “What good is a product if people can’t use it?” In the world of product development, this remark holds immense significance. We, the product developers, frequently underestimate this facet.

How you introduce your product to customers plays a pivotal role in determining how it will be received in the market. It is akin to the culinary world, where the presentation of a dish distinguishes an experienced chef from a novice. Similarly, in product development, the way a product is packaged and presented can signifi-

cantly influence the impression it leaves on customers.

Consider this analogy to appreciate the impact of presentation in product development—just as a beautifully plated meal can enhance the dining experience, the way a product is presented can elevate its appeal and desirability in the eyes of potential buyers.

Functions of packaging

Often, we tend to treat the packaging as an extra item that gets discarded after the customer buys the product. Such an attitude to packaging is not correct. Let us examine the functions that a well-designed product packaging must perform to understand its needs.

Product protection. The main job of prod-